THESIS — Investment Decision Intelligence Platform

Product Ideation Document v2.0 (Revised)

This version restructures v1.0 to fix seven structural risks and four gaps identified in review. Nothing about the core insight changes — the sequencing, trust mechanics, and honesty of the projections do.

WHAT CHANGED FROM v1.0, AND WHY

#	Problem in v1.0	Fix in v2.0
1	Thesis-writing treated as a "2-minute template," but writing quantified assumptions is homework with high drop-off	Tiered, mostly auto-generated thesis capture (§4.1). MVP entry point reordered to X-Ray-first if thesis adoption fails validation.
2	Auto-parsed alerts treated as a pure engineering problem; one wrong number breaks the "rigor" brand	New Confidence & Provenance Layer + public accuracy dashboard + error-recovery protocol (§4.6, new)
3	Decision Quality Score's best insights need 12-18 months of personal history — no early payoff	Two-track scoring: cohort-relative (Day 1) + personal-longitudinal (unlocks over time, gamified) (§4.5)
4	Monetization assumed optimistic conversion off a homework-heavy free product	Conservative base case, paywall moved to passive/high-perceived-value features, not to the thesis input mechanism (§8)

#	Problem in v1.0	Fix in v2.0
5	Moat argument leaned on X-Ray/cross-asset integration, which incumbents can copy in months	Moat re-ranked by "half-life"; decision journal pulled into MVP Phase 1 as the actual defensible asset (§9)
6	B2B RIA motion bolted onto Phase 4 with the same 4-6 person team	B2B explicitly deferred to pilot-only status until a dedicated hire exists (§10, §14)
7	Templated "pre-committed action" language and the "algo trading regs = tailwind" framing both carry advisory-classification risk	Alerts now echo the user's own rule text verbatim; explicit compliance checkpoint added before Phase 1 launch (§7)
—	No paid acquisition plan	Added (§10.3)
—	No trust-recovery mechanism for bad data	Added (§4.6)
—	No cost-vs-revenue stress test	Added (§8.3)
—	No language/regional strategy despite tier-2/3 being where account growth actually is	Added (§10.4, §12)

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1. THE CORE INSIGHT (unchanged)

Thesis is the operating system for how India invests — not what to buy, but whether your reasons for buying are any good.

Indian retail investors (190M+ demat accounts, 2026) don't lose money for lack of data. They lose money to thesis drift, invisible concentration, absent exit frameworks, IPO FOMO, and recency bias. Thesis doesn't tell you what to buy. It tells you whether your own reasoning is rigorous, whether your portfolio is doing what you think it's doing, and exactly when your reasons for holding something stop being valid.

Mental model, unchanged: **Grammarly for investment decisions.**

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2. MARKET CONTEXT & WHY NOW

Demand-side facts are unchanged from v1.0 (190M+ demat accounts, ₹25,000 Cr+ monthly SIP flows, 200+ IPOs in 2024-26, SEBI literacy surveys). One addition:

2.1 The regulatory tailwind is not one-directional

v1.0 treated SEBI's April 2026 algo-trading regulations purely as validation ("legitimized AI-assisted analysis tools"). That's half true. The same framework that legitimizes systematic, rules-based tools also raises the bar for anything that *resembles* automated advice — including user-configured alerting that nudges toward action. This is addressed directly in §7. The practical implication: legal review of Thesis's specific alert mechanics against this framework happens **before** MVP launch, not as a background risk-register line item.

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3. WHAT THESIS ACTUALLY IS (unchanged)

Analysis, not advisory. Process over prediction. Cross-asset truth. Thesis-first investing. See v1.0 for full philosophy — this hasn't changed; only how it's delivered has.

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4. THE ENGINES (REVISED)

4.1 Engine 1: Thesis Builder & Monitor — now tiered

The single biggest risk in v1.0 was assuming users will write structured investment theses on demand. They mostly won't, on day one, for a blank page. So the ask is staged:

Tier 0 — Auto-drafted (zero user effort). When a position is added or imported, an LLM generates a *starter thesis* from public data and disclosed sector/analyst commentary: "Most investors hold INFY for enterprise AI-driven consulting growth; margin band 20-23%; EBIT sensitivity to USD/INR." This is clearly labeled as a **generic starting point, not personalized advice**, and the user accepts, edits, or discards it with one tap.

Tier 1 — Templated refinement (30 seconds). User picks from 3-4 pre-built thesis frameworks common for that stock/sector (bull case, value case, turnaround case, momentum case) and adjusts thresholds with sliders, not free text.

Tier 2 — Full manual (power users). The complete guided builder from v1.0, for users who want to write everything themselves.

Why this matters: it removes the blank-page problem that kills adoption, while still producing a monitorable, quantified thesis for every position — which is the whole point of the product. The moment *any* thesis exists (even Tier 0), the user gets their first Thesis Health Score and an X-Ray teaser. Value is immediate, not deferred.

Explicit MVP validation gate: success is defined as ≥40% of imported positions carrying at least a Tier 0/1 thesis by end of the user's first session. If this fails in beta, the entry point flips — X-Ray becomes the front door (passive, no writing required) and thesis-building becomes a second-session upsell rather than the onboarding gate. This contingency is now a planned fallback, not a post-mortem.

4.2 Engine 2: Portfolio X-Ray (Cross-Asset Exposure) — unchanged mechanics, reprioritized role

Functionally the same as v1.0 (unified import, overlap detection, sector concentration, factor exposure, correlation matrix). What changes is its role in the roadmap: it moves earlier (see §11) because it's the feature most likely to be the actual acquisition hook if thesis-writing under-performs, and it's the feature most vulnerable to being copied — so it should generate word-of-mouth fast rather than being saved for Phase 2.

4.3 Engine 3: IPO Forensics (unchanged)

Same five-section forensic structure as v1.0. No changes to mechanics; sequencing addressed in §11.

4.4 Engine 4: Exit Intelligence — alert language rewritten for compliance

Mechanically unchanged (pre-committed exit rules, automated monitoring, decision log). One critical rewrite:

v1.0 language (risk):

> YOUR PRE-COMMITTED ACTION: Review and consider exiting

This is platform-generated directive language, even if framed as "pre-committed." A regulator reading it sees Thesis telling a user to consider exiting a specific security.

v2.0 language (fix):

> YOUR RULE (set by you on [date]): *"[verbatim text the user typed or selected when creating the rule]"* STATUS: This condition is now met.

The alert **echoes the user's own words**, captured verbatim at rule-creation time, rather than paraphrasing into a new directive. No platform-authored verbs like "consider exiting" appear anywhere in the alert. This is a small UI change with real compliance weight, and it's a hard requirement for Phase 1, not a nice-to-have.

4.5 Engine 5: Decision Quality Score — two-track, to fix the cold-start problem

v1.0's most compelling DQS insights ("your overrides cost you ₹1,43,000") require 12-18 months of personal decision history. That's a long time to ask a paying user to wait for the product's signature feature to say anything interesting. Fix: split into two tracks.

Track A — Cohort-relative (available Day 1). Uses anonymized aggregate data across all users, not the individual's own history: "Your thesis rigor is 72; the top 10% of users average 88." This is available to a user on day one because it's benchmarked against everyone else, not against their own past.

Track B — Personal-longitudinal (unlocks progressively). Override-outcome patterns, panic-sell frequency, holding-period discipline — the deep insights from v1.0 — unlock explicitly as history accumulates, with a visible progress indicator: *"2 more logged decisions to unlock your override pattern report."* This reframes a limitation (no data yet) as a specifically-gamified engagement loop, and sets honest expectations instead of implying day-one insight the product can't yet deliver.

4.6 NEW — Confidence & Provenance Layer (fixes the alert-trust cliff)

This didn't exist in v1.0 and is the single highest-priority addition. A product whose pitch is "trust our rigor over your gut" cannot afford a wrong alert without a plan for what happens next.

- **Every data point feeding an alert carries a confidence label and a source link.** "Confirmed" = passed rule-based cross-validation (e.g., segment revenues sum to the reported total). "Preliminary" = LLM-extracted, not yet cross-checked — visually distinct, softer language ("preliminary data suggests..."), never auto-triggers an irreversible-feeling alert state on its own.
- **Public accuracy dashboard.** Thesis publishes its own parsing accuracy rate per data type, updated continuously — turning what's normally a hidden liability into a visible trust signal, the same way uptime pages work for infrastructure products.
- **Error-recovery protocol.** If a user flags a bad parse, the correction has a committed SLA, the affected alert is retracted or amended, and the user is notified transparently

rather than silently. This protocol is designed and shipped *with* the MVP, not bolted on after the first embarrassing mistake.
- **Coverage starts narrow.** Auto-alerting launches on the ~50 most liquid, best-covered stocks (not the 200 in v1.0), expanding only as backtested accuracy on historical filings clears a defined bar (99.5%+ on financial figures). Slower, but it protects the brand the product is built on.

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5. CROSS-ASSET UNIFIED VIEW (unchanged)

Stocks, mutual funds, IPOs, ETFs, and government securities are unified as in v1.0 — see original structure. No changes to asset coverage, only to sequencing (§11) and trust mechanics (§4.6) layered on top.

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6. DATA ARCHITECTURE & SOURCES (unchanged, with one sequencing rule)

Same public-data sources and pipeline as v1.0 (BSE/NSE, AMFI, SEBI, RBI, CAS uploads). New rule, driven by the cost stress test in §8.3: **no paid data source is added until MVP + Phase 2 are validated on free/public sources alone.** This is a sequencing constraint on the architecture, not a technology change.

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7. SEBI COMPLIANCE MODEL — tightened

The core boundary is unchanged: Thesis never issues buy/sell/hold recommendations; it shows users their own data and their own rules. Two additions given the regulatory risk in §2.1 and §4.4:

1. **Verbatim-echo requirement.** As in §4.4, no platform-authored directive language appears in any alert. The platform surfaces facts and the user's own prior words; it never phrases a next step.
2. **Pre-launch compliance checkpoint.** A specific legal review of the April 2026 algo-trading framework against Thesis's alerting mechanics is a scheduled MVP milestone — not a general "legal review" line item in the risk register, but a gating step before any alert ships to real users. If counsel flags the automated alert-triggering itself (independent of language) as within scope of the new framework, the fallback is to make

all thesis-breaker notifications pull-based (user checks a dashboard) rather than push-based (proactive notification) until registration status is clarified.

Everything else in v1.0's compliance section (no top picks, no price targets, no model portfolios, audit trail) carries over unchanged.

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8. MONETIZATION & UNIT ECONOMICS — revised, more conservative

8.1 Pricing tiers — same price points, different gating logic

The prices are unchanged (Free / Pro ₹349/mo / Premium ₹799/mo / B2B ₹5-15K per seat), but **what's gated has changed.** v1.0 gated "unlimited thesis tracking" behind Pro — but thesis creation is the input mechanism the whole product depends on, so charging for more of it discourages the exact behavior the product needs to succeed. v2.0 keeps thesis creation unlimited on the free tier and instead gates:

- Full-depth X-Ray (free tier gets one full "shock reveal" of their complete overlap picture once, then a teaser view afterward — a proven freemium hook)
- Unlimited IPO forensic reports (free: 1/month, unchanged)
- All proactive alerting (free tier can see thesis health scores on-demand; only paid tiers get push notifications)
- Track B personal-longitudinal DQS insights (Track A cohort-relative score stays free)

8.2 Revised conversion assumptions

v1.0 assumed 5% Year 1 conversion rising to 10% by Year 3, off a product with a homework-heavy free tier. With the paywall moved to passive/high-value features rather than the input mechanism, conversion should be less friction-limited on one axis but the market for paid "process discipline" tools is still unproven in India, so the base case is set lower with explicit scenarios:

Scenario	**Year 1 conversion**	**Year 3 conversion**
Downside	2%	5%
Base case	3.5%	7%
Upside	5%	10%

Revenue projections should be modeled against the base case, with v1.0's original 5%→10% figures kept only as the upside case.

8.3 NEW — Cost stress test against Year 1 revenue

v1.0 never checked its own data-cost table against its own revenue table. Doing that math: Year 1 base-case revenue (2,500 paid users × ~₹300 blended ARPU × 12) is roughly ₹90L. v1.0's paid data sources alone were quoted at ₹5-15L/year for baseline coverage across BSE StAR MF, NSE feed, CMIE/Capitaline — 5-17% of Year 1 revenue before compute, LLM costs, or infrastructure. Combined with LLM API costs for DRHP parsing and results extraction, a 75% Year 1 gross margin (as claimed in v1.0) is optimistic if any paid feeds are live in Year 1.

Fix: MVP through Phase 2 runs entirely on free/public sources (BSE/NSE bhavcopy, AMFI monthly disclosures, SEBI filings) — sufficient for the top 50-200 stocks the product targets initially anyway. Paid data sources are added only once Phase 3 revenue can absorb them without compressing margin below 65% in the model. This is now a stated architectural constraint (§6), not just a spreadsheet assumption.

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9. COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE & MOAT — re-ranked by durability

v1.0 listed four moats without ranking how long each survives an incumbent's engineering sprint. That ranking matters for what to build first.

Moat	**Estimated half-life against a well-resourced incumbent (Tickertape, INDmoney, Groww)**	**Implication**
Cross-asset X-Ray / overlap detection	~6-9 months — incumbents already hold the BSE/AMFI data pipes; this is an integration project for them, not a research problem	Build fast, use for acquisition, don't over-invest defensively
DRHP parsing accuracy	~12 months — genuinely hard, but replicable with enough engineering investment	Real but temporary technical moat

Moat	Estimated half-life against a well-resourced incumbent (Tickertape, INDmoney, Groww)	Implication
Decision journal (thesis history, exit-rule overrides, outcomes)	Compounds indefinitely — it's *this specific user's* history, non-transferable, and gets more valuable the longer they stay	The actual long-term moat

Consequence for the roadmap: decision logging (hold/exit/override capture, even in its simplest form) is pulled forward into MVP Phase 1, rather than arriving in Phase 3 as in v1.0. It doesn't need mutual fund integration or IPO forensics to start compounding — it only needs a user making decisions on the stock positions they already have in the MVP.

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10. GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY — revised

10.1 Phase 1: Content-led (Months 0-6) — unchanged

Fintwit case studies, YouTube walkthroughs, finance-YouTuber partnerships as in v1.0.

10.2 Phase 2: Community & virality (Months 6-12) — unchanged

Shareable X-Ray cards, referral program as in v1.0.

10.3 NEW — Paid acquisition (starts Month 4-6, not Day 0)

v1.0 had no paid channel at all, which is a real gap for a product that needs volume to feed its cohort-relative DQS scoring and its behavioral data moat. Once there's early product-market signal from content (not before — no point buying traffic into an unvalidated funnel):

- Bottom-of-funnel search intent: "mutual fund overlap checker," "IPO analysis India," "portfolio diversification checker"
- Lookalike audiences built from engaged free users (high-X-Ray-usage cohort)
- Newsletter/podcast sponsorships adjacent to existing finance content audiences (Varsity-adjacent, INVESTED-style channels) rather than building a from-scratch paid brand campaign

Budget should stay modest and CAC-tracked against Pro-tier LTV explicitly — this channel exists to compound the organic motion, not replace it.

10.4 NEW — Regional language and tier-2/3 strategy

v1.0's GTM was entirely English, fintwit-centric — but demat account growth is disproportionately coming from tier-2/3 cities where fintwit isn't the dominant discovery channel. Hindi UI and Hindi-language content distribution (YouTube, WhatsApp-shareable X-Ray cards) is added explicitly as a Phase 2 item, not left as an unstated future nice-to-have. This doesn't require a full multi-language product on day one — it requires the shareable, viral-loop artifacts (X-Ray cards, IPO track record cards) to exist in Hindi early, since those are the pieces most likely to travel outside the English-speaking fintwit bubble.

10.5 Phase 3: B2B — deferred and scoped down (see §14)

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11. MVP SCOPE & PHASED ROADMAP — restructured

MVP (Months 1-4): "Thesis + Decision Log for Stocks"

Build:

- Tiered thesis builder (Tier 0/1/2) for direct stocks — §4.1
- Decision logging from day one: every hold/exit/override is captured, even before there's enough history to analyze it — §9
- Thesis health monitoring on the ~50 most liquid, best-covered stocks only, with the Confidence & Provenance Layer live from the start — §4.6
- Cohort-relative DQS (Track A) — available immediately, no personal history required
- Pre-launch compliance checkpoint against the April 2026 algo-trading framework — §7
- Web app only

Explicit validation gates (both must be checked before Phase 2 funding/build):

1. ≥40% of imported positions get at least a Tier 0/1 thesis in the first session (§4.1)
2. Parsing accuracy on the 50-stock universe clears 99.5% on backtested historical filings before any alert goes live (§4.6)

If gate 1 fails: flip the entry point — X-Ray becomes the front door in Phase 2, thesis-building becomes a second-session upsell rather than onboarding gate.

Phase 2 (Months 4-8): "Portfolio X-Ray"

Same scope as v1.0 (CAS upload, cross-asset overlap, sector concentration, factor exposure) — sequencing unchanged, but now benefits from decision-logging data already accumulating

since Month 1. Hindi-language shareable cards added here (§10.4). Paid data sources still off (§8.3).

Phase 3 (Months 8-12): "IPO Forensics + Exit Intelligence, Track B unlocks"

DRHP parsing, full exit intelligence with the verbatim-echo alert language (§4.4), Track B personal-longitudinal DQS begins unlocking for early users who now have 6-8+ months of decision history. Mobile app launch. Broker API integrations begin.

Phase 4 (Months 12-18): "Selective B2B pilots + scale"

Not a full B2B build-out — see §14 for the resourcing constraint. Multi-portfolio support, backtesting engine, and API access for power users proceed as in v1.0.

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12. LOCALIZATION (NEW SECTION)

Given account growth is concentrated outside metro/English-first fintwit audiences: Hindi-language shareable artifacts ship in Phase 2 (§10.4), full Hindi UI is evaluated for Phase 3 based on engagement data from the Phase 2 shareable cards, and regional-language expansion beyond Hindi (Tamil, Marathi, Bengali) is explicitly deferred past the 18-month roadmap pending signal — not promised prematurely, not ignored entirely.

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13. RISK REGISTER — updated

Risk	**Severity**	**Probability**	**Mitigation**
SEBI regulatory action (classified as advisory)	Critical	Low	Verbatim-echo alert language, pre-launch compliance checkpoint against April 2026 algo-trading framework, pull-based fallback if push alerts are flagged (§7)

Risk	Severity	Probability	Mitigation
Users don't write theses even in tiered form	High	Medium	Tiered Tier 0/1/2 capture with explicit validation gate and a planned X-Ray-first fallback if it fails (§4.1, §11)
Wrong alert damages trust in a rigor-branded product	Critical	Medium	Confidence & Provenance Layer, public accuracy dashboard, committed error-correction SLA, narrow initial coverage (§4.6)
DQS has nothing to say for the first several months per user	Medium	High (by design, until fixed)	Two-track scoring — cohort-relative available Day 1 (§4.5)
Data source disruption (BSE/NSE format changes)	Medium	Medium	Multiple redundant sources, actively maintained parsers (unchanged from v1.0)
Paid data costs erode Year 1 margin	Medium	Medium (was previously unmodeled)	MVP + Phase 2 run entirely on free/public sources; paid feeds added only once revenue supports <65% margin compression (§8.3)
Incumbent copies X-Ray feature	High	High	Accept this moat is short-lived (§9); pull decision-journal moat forward instead
Low conversion from free to paid	High	Medium	Conservative 3.5% base-case Year 1

Risk	Severity	Probability	Mitigation
			conversion modeled explicitly, paywall moved off the thesis input mechanism (§8.2)
Small team overstretched by B2B + consumer motions simultaneously	High	High (in v1.0's plan)	B2B deferred to pilot-only until dedicated hire exists (§14)
Privacy breach of portfolio data	Critical	Low	Encryption, SOC2 by Year 2, India data residency (unchanged)

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14. TEAM COMPOSITION — resourcing constraint added

Same 4-6 person initial team as v1.0 (Founder/CEO, two full-stack engineers, one data/LLM engineer, Phase 2 designer and growth hire). **Explicit constraint added:** B2B RIA sales is not run by this team as a side motion. Through Month 18, B2B activity is limited to 2-3 hand-held design-partner pilots run directly by the founder, with no dedicated B2B sales GTM until a dedicated B2B hire is made — realistically post-Series A. This replaces v1.0's implicit assumption that the same small team executes both a content-led consumer PLG motion and a relationship-driven enterprise sales motion concurrently.

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15. SUMMARY: WHY v2.0 IS THE BUILDABLE VERSION

1. **The core wedge is unchanged and still the strongest part of this idea** — "is your reasoning good," not "what to buy," remains a real product/regulatory alignment that no competitor occupies.
2. **The biggest execution risk (thesis-writing adoption) now has a staged solution and a pre-defined fallback**, instead of an optimistic assumption.
3. **The biggest trust risk (bad alerts on a rigor-branded product) now has a dedicated system**, not just an engineering to-do.

4. **The moat argument is honest about what's actually defensible** (decision history) versus what's a temporary lead (X-Ray, DRHP parsing) — and the roadmap now reflects that ranking.
5. **The financial model has been checked against itself** — data costs against revenue, conversion assumptions against a homework-heavy free product — and downgraded where the original was optimistic.
6. **B2B and consumer are no longer competing for the same four people's attention** in the critical first 18 months.
7. **Compliance is designed into the alert mechanics themselves**, not treated as a document to file once and forget.

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